

# Switching on stock tracking

Everything on the system side is built and running. Three lists from your kitchen are all that stand between you and knowing, every morning, what you used, what you have, and what to buy.

## **What this is for**

Your kitchen team, over about a week.

## **What you get at the end**

A restock list you can order from, and a report that shows where stock is going.

## What you get, once the lists are in

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Today the till records every sale correctly. What it cannot do yet is tell you what those sales *cost you in stock*, because it does not know what is in your dishes.

Once it does, three things happen on their own, every day:

### 1 Selling a dish takes its ingredients off the shelf

Sell four steaks, and the beef and oil they used come off your stock. No one types anything.

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### 2 A restock list tells you what to buy

Open `Restock List` and it shows what has fallen below the level you set, and how much to order.

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### 3 A second report shows where stock is going

`Consumption Variance` compares what your recipes say you should have used against what actually left the shelf. A steady gap is over-portioning, spoilage, or something walking out of the door.

**Why we are asking rather than guessing.** We could invent an ingredient list and a set of recipes for you in an afternoon. Every number the system then produced would be fiction, and you would make ordering decisions on it. The lists below are the difference between a system that reports and one that guesses.

## List 1 · What you buy

Every raw item that comes through your back door, and the unit you buy it in. Not dishes — ingredients.

### WHAT WE NEED FOR EACH ONE

| COLUMN         | MEANING                                  | EXAMPLE           |
|----------------|------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| Item           | What you call it in the kitchen          | Beef, topside     |
| Unit           | How you buy and count it                 | Kg                |
| Typical price  | Roughly what you pay per unit, in KES    | 720               |
| Supplier       | Who you usually buy it from              | Kariokor Butchery |
| Reorder at     | The level where you would start worrying | 10                |
| Order how much | Your usual order size                    | 25                |

**The unit matters more than anything else here.** Pick the unit you actually count in, and stay with it. If you buy cooking oil in 20-litre jerry cans but measure it into pans in millilitres, tell us both — we set the conversion up once and you never think about it again. Getting this wrong is the one mistake that is painful to correct later.

### HOW LONG THIS TAKES

Most kitchens land between 60 and 120 ingredients. A chef who knows the store can usually write it in a morning. Start with the things you buy every week — the last few rare items can follow.

## List 2 · What is on the shelf right now

One physical count, on the day you start. This is the opening balance everything else counts from.

| ITEM          | COUNTED | UNIT  |
|---------------|---------|-------|
| Beef, topside | 14.5    | Kg    |
| Cooking oil   | 38      | Litre |
| Tomatoes      | 22      | Kg    |

**Count on a closed day if you can** — after service, before the next delivery. A count taken while the kitchen is cooking is wrong before you finish writing it.

If an item is genuinely at zero, write zero. Leaving it blank and leaving it out are different things, and only one of them is true.

## List 3 · What goes into each dish

The one that takes real time, and the one that makes the other two worth having. For each dish on your menu: the ingredients, and how much of each.

### EXAMPLE — ONE PLATE OF BEEF STEAK

| INGREDIENT    | AMOUNT | UNIT  |
|---------------|--------|-------|
| Beef, topside | 0.25   | Kg    |
| Cooking oil   | 0.02   | Litre |
| Salt          | 0.005  | Kg    |

Amounts are **per plate as served**, not per batch — unless you cook in batches, in which case tell us the batch size and we handle the division.

### YOU DO NOT NEED ALL 170 DISHES TO START

Start with the twenty or thirty that sell most. They account for the overwhelming majority of what leaves your store, and they give you a working system this week rather than a perfect one next month. The rest can be added any time, by you, without calling us.

**Sauces and preps that you make in batches** — a house sauce, a spice mix, a stock — are worth listing as their own recipe rather than repeating their ingredients inside every dish. Tell us which ones you make ahead and we will set them up that way.

## How to send them

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Any of these works. Pick whichever is least effort for your team:

- A spreadsheet — one tab per list, columns as shown above.
- A written list, photographed clearly. Handwriting is fine.
- Typed straight into the system yourself. If you would rather do this, say so and we will show you where — it is the same three screens you will use afterwards anyway.

Send List 1 as soon as it is written; it does not need to wait for the other two. We load it, set your units up, and then Lists 2 and 3 go in quickly.

## Running it day to day

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Once the lists are in, this is the whole of it. None of it needs us.

### Closing the day

Press **Close day** on the floor screen when service ends. It shows what it is about to bank — the takings and how many bills — and asks you to confirm.

If any tables still have unpaid checks, it will say so and refuse. That is deliberate: closing over an open check leaves that table with no way to be billed. Settle them, then close.

**Close every night.** A day left open bills the next morning's sales into yesterday, and eventually the till starts refusing sales as "outdated". If that happens, the button will read **Close day (yesterday)** — press it and you are back to normal.

### Recording waste

When something is spoiled, dropped, or eaten by staff, record it with a reason. It takes a few seconds and it is what keeps the variance report honest — otherwise every loss looks like theft.

### Ordering

Open **Restock List**. Anything below its reorder level is marked, with a suggested quantity. Order from it, and record the delivery when it arrives so the count goes back up.

### Checking for leaks

Open **Consumption Variance** weekly. Small gaps are normal — nobody portions to the gram. Look for the same item drifting week after week, which usually means the recipe is wrong or portions have crept.

### Changing things yourself

Recipes, prices, reorder levels, new ingredients and new dishes are all yours to change, whenever you like. A recipe change applies to sales from that point on; it does not rewrite history.

## In short

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| WHAT                                  | WHO                      | ROUGHLY    |
|---------------------------------------|--------------------------|------------|
| List 1 — what you buy                 | Your chef or storekeeper | A morning  |
| List 2 — opening count                | Whoever counts stock     | An evening |
| List 3 — recipes for your top sellers | Your chef                | A few days |
| Loading it and switching on           | Us                       | Same week  |

Send List 1 when it is ready and we will start. Anything unclear above, ask — a wrong list is more expensive than a slow one.